

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA STATUTORY REGULATORY REPOSITORY

AYURLEX COMPLIANCE HANDBOOK — THE AYURVEDIC PHARMACOPOEIA (API) & FORMULARY (AFI)

4. The Ayurvedic Pharmacopoeia (API) & Formulary (AFI)

Domain Identifier: ayush / api | Statutory Body: Pharmacopoeia Commission for Indian Medicine & Homoeopathy (PCIM&H;)

Statutory Benchmark: Under Section 33E and 33EEA of the Drugs & Cosmetics Act, standards published in the Ayurvedic Pharmacopoeia of India are legally binding quality benchmarks for purity, identity, and assay.

Pharmacopoeial Structure & Monographs:

- **API Part I (Single Drugs — Volumes I to IX):** Contains 600+ legal monographs detailing botanical names, Sanskrit synonyms, macroscopic/microscopic characteristics, foreign organic matter (<2%), total ash, acid-insoluble ash, extractive values, and TLC/HPTLC fingerprinting.
- **API Part II (Formulations — Volumes I to IV):** Standardized monographs for classical generic formulations (Asavas, Arishtas, Avalehas, Churnas, Tailas, Ghritas, Bhasmas, Guggulus, and Vatis).
- **Ayurvedic Formulary of India (AFI — Parts I, II & III):** Master canonical recipes specifying exact proportions of raw ingredients, traditional manufacturing processes (Samskaras), and shelf-life indications.
- **Statutory Contaminant Limits:**
 - Heavy Metals: Lead (Pb) ≤ 10 ppm; Arsenic (As) ≤ 3 ppm; Cadmium (Cd) ≤ 0.3 ppm; Mercury (Hg) ≤ 1 ppm.
 - Microbial Limits: Total viable aerobic count ≤ 10^5 CFU/g; Total yeast and mould ≤ 10^3 CFU/g; E. coli, Salmonella, Pseudomonas aeruginosa, and S. aureus must be completely absent.

Optimal RAG Queries for this Dataset:

1. 'What are the official API standards for Ashwagandha root (Withania somnifera)?' → Returns botanical assay, ash limits, and TLC Rf markers.
2. 'What are the statutory heavy metal limits for Ayurvedic medicines?' → Returns Lead, Arsenic, Cadmium, and Mercury thresholds.
3. 'What is the shelf life of Asava and Arishta under the Ayurvedic Pharmacopoeia?' → Returns fermentation stability rules.